

Visual Navigation for Autonomous Vehicles

Last Lecture – Overview

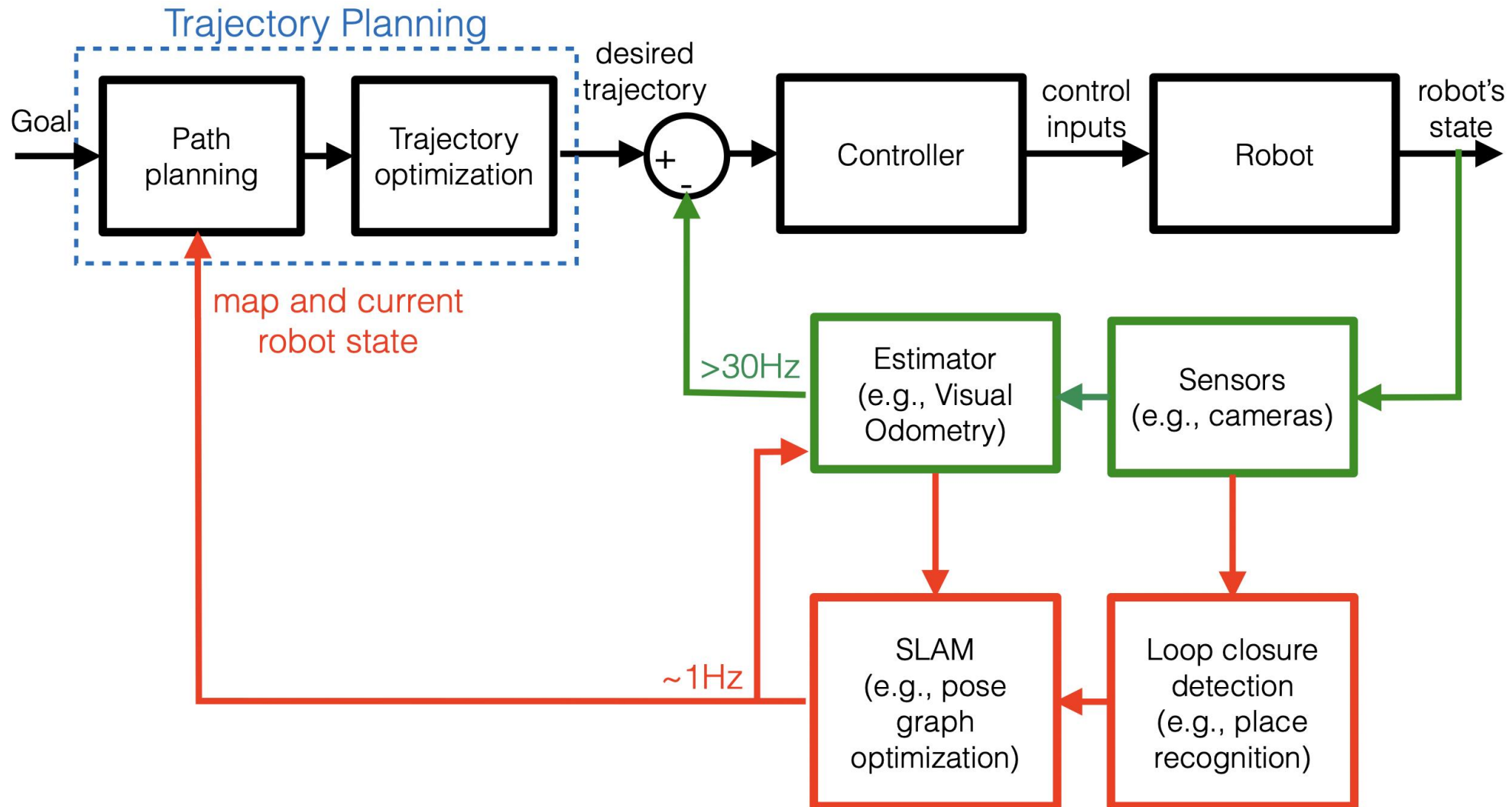
Self-driving Cars



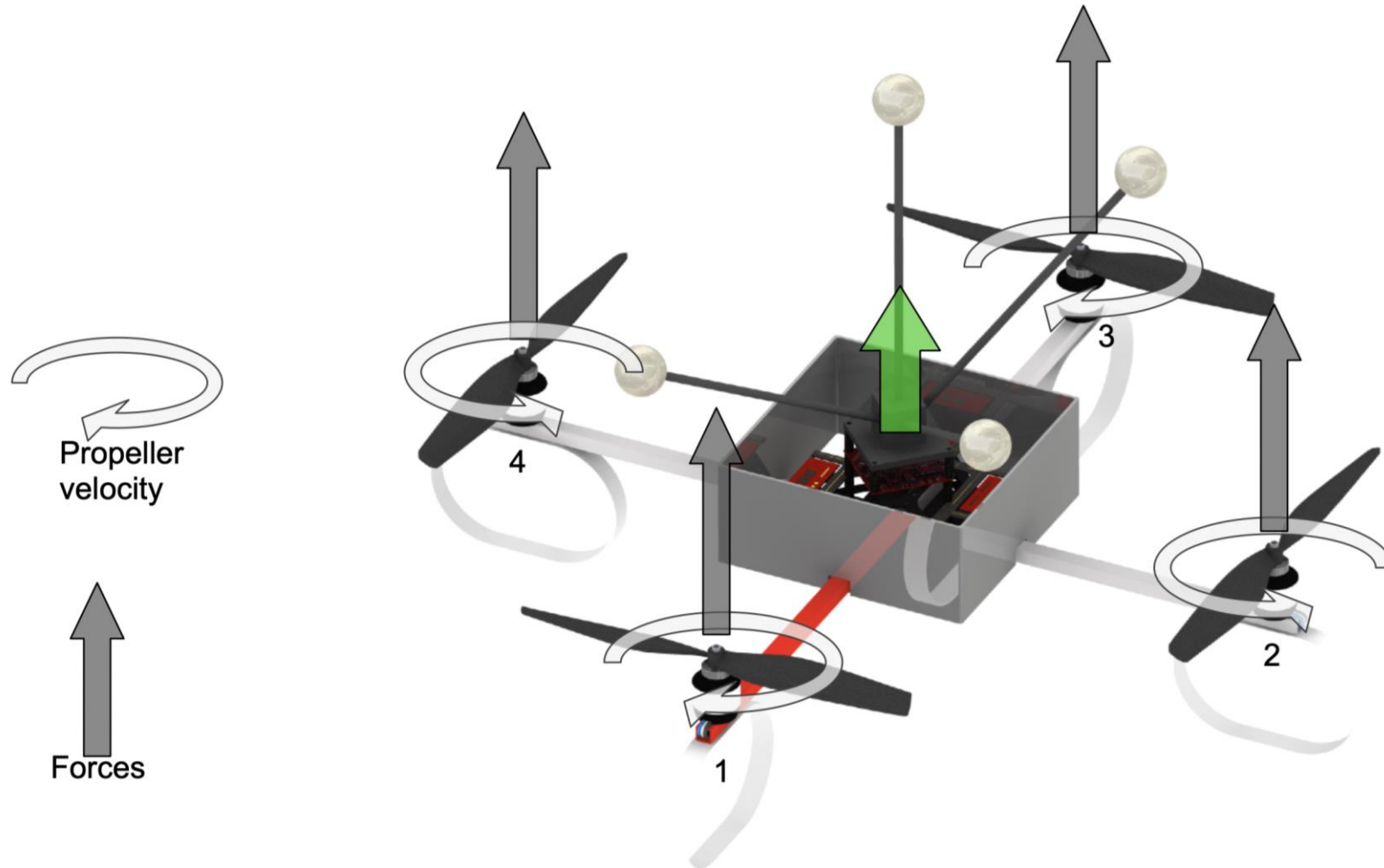
Self-flying Drones



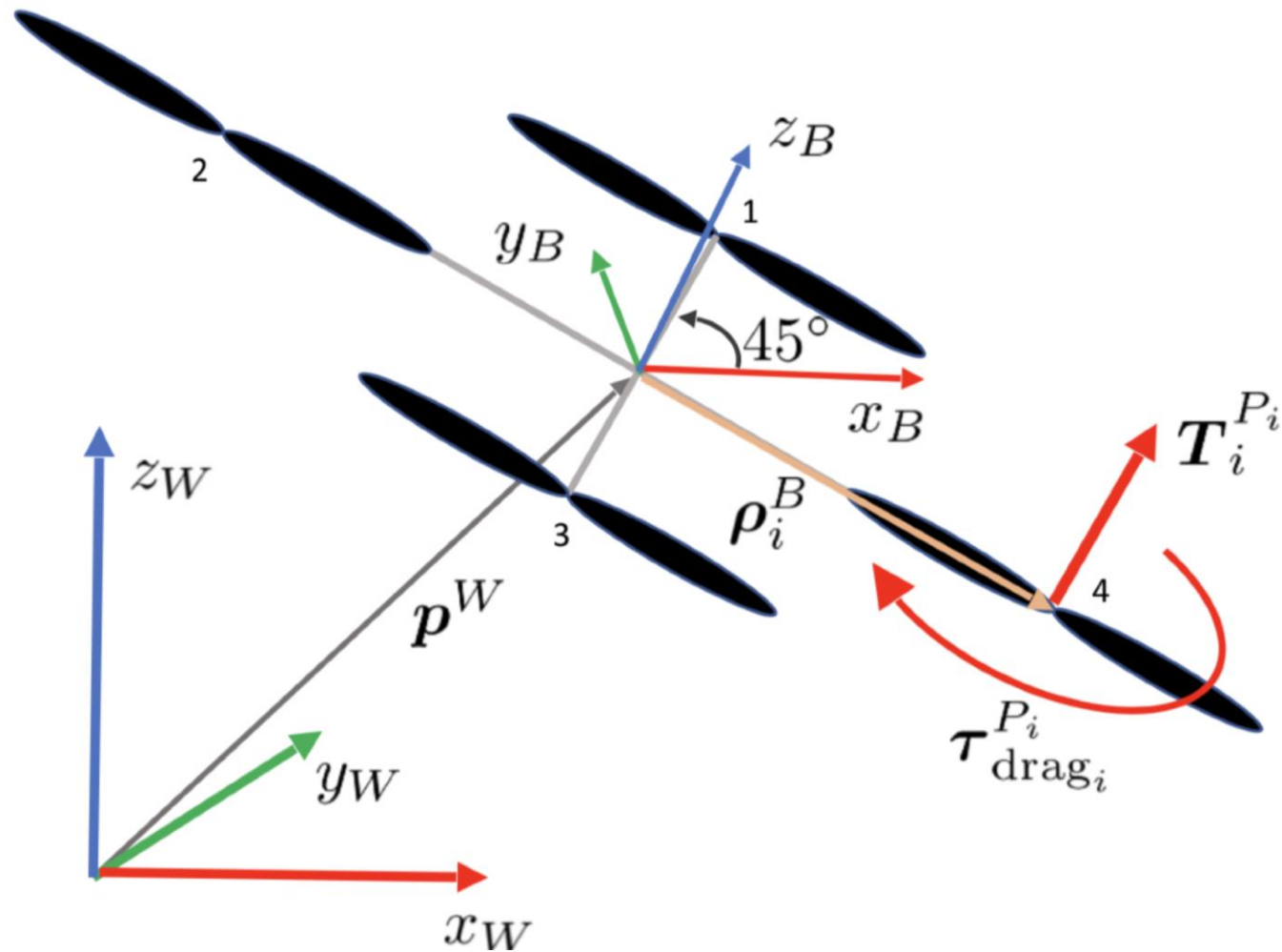
What we have covered in this course...



Quadrotor Dynamics



Quadrotor Dynamics



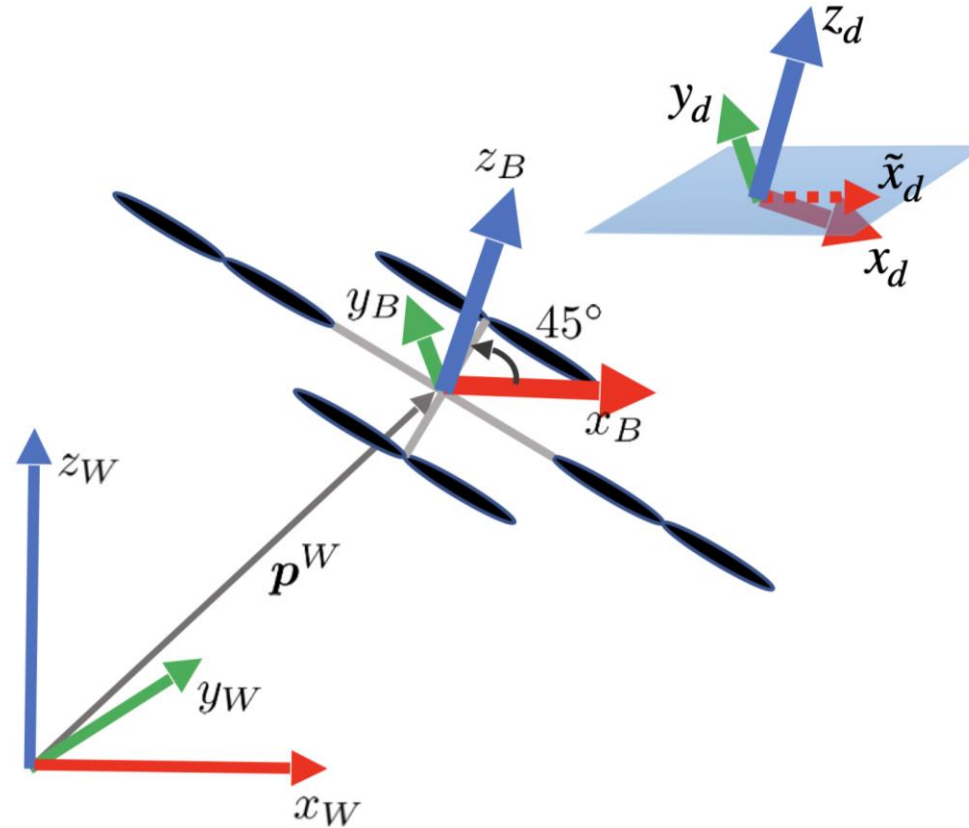
$$\begin{bmatrix} m\boldsymbol{a}^{\text{w}} \\ \boldsymbol{\mathcal{J}}\boldsymbol{\alpha}^{\text{B}} \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} m\boldsymbol{g}^{\text{w}} \\ -\boldsymbol{\omega}^{\text{B}} \times \boldsymbol{\mathcal{J}}\boldsymbol{\omega}^{\text{B}} \end{bmatrix} + \begin{bmatrix} \boldsymbol{R}_{\text{B}}^{\text{w}} & \boldsymbol{0} \\ \boldsymbol{0} & \boldsymbol{I}_3 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} \boldsymbol{f}_{thrust}^{\text{B}} \\ \boldsymbol{\tau}_{drag}^{\text{B}} + \boldsymbol{\tau}_{thrust}^{\text{B}} \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} -mg\boldsymbol{e}_3 \\ -\boldsymbol{\omega}^{\text{B}} \times \boldsymbol{\mathcal{J}}\boldsymbol{\omega}^{\text{B}} \end{bmatrix} + \begin{bmatrix} \boldsymbol{R}_{\text{B}}^{\text{w}} & \boldsymbol{0} \\ \boldsymbol{0} & \boldsymbol{I}_3 \end{bmatrix} \boldsymbol{F}\boldsymbol{w}$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} f_x^{\text{B}} \\ f_y^{\text{B}} \\ f_z^{\text{B}} \\ \tau_x^{\text{B}} \\ \tau_y^{\text{B}} \\ \tau_z^{\text{B}} \end{bmatrix} = \boldsymbol{F}\boldsymbol{w} = \begin{bmatrix} c_f\boldsymbol{e}_3 & c_f\boldsymbol{e}_3 & c_f\boldsymbol{e}_3 & c_f\boldsymbol{e}_3 \\ c_d\boldsymbol{e}_3 + c_f\boldsymbol{\rho}_1^{\text{B}} \times \boldsymbol{e}_3 & -c_d\boldsymbol{e}_3 + c_f\boldsymbol{\rho}_2^{\text{B}} \times \boldsymbol{e}_3 & c_d\boldsymbol{e}_3 + c_f\boldsymbol{\rho}_3^{\text{B}} \times \boldsymbol{e}_3 & -c_d\boldsymbol{e}_3 + c_f\boldsymbol{\rho}_4^{\text{B}} \times \boldsymbol{e}_3 \end{bmatrix} \boldsymbol{w}$$

Geometric Controller

$$R_B^W = [x_B^W \ y_B^W \ z_B^W]$$

$$R_d^W = [x_d^W \ y_d^W \ z_d^W]$$



Geometric Controller

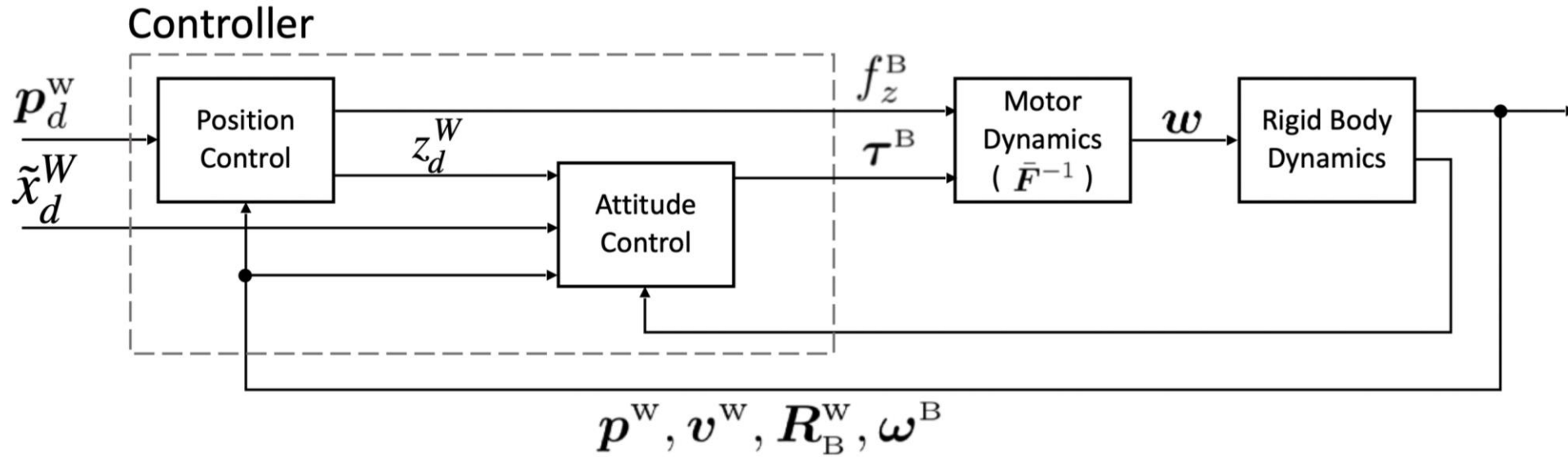
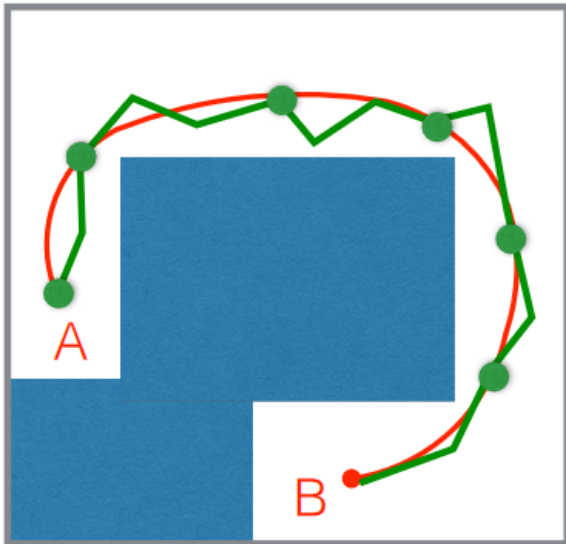
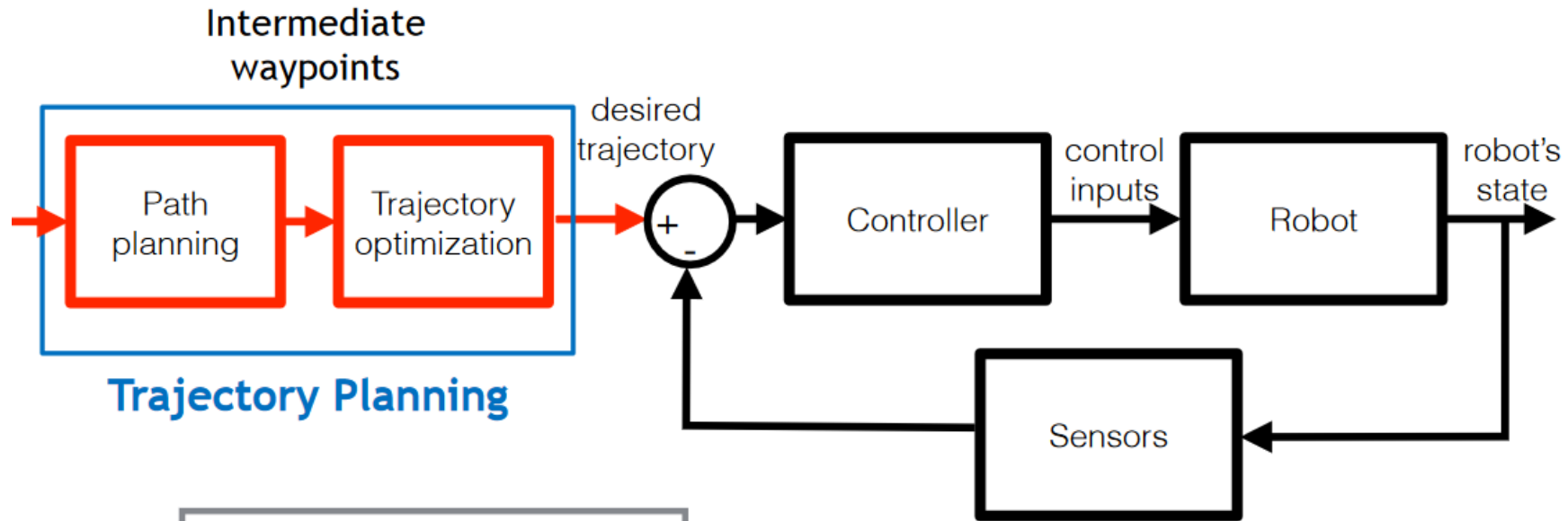


Figure 7.2: The geometric control loops for position and attitude control.

$$\begin{bmatrix} f_x^B \\ f_y^B \\ f_z^B \\ \tau_x^B \\ \tau_y^B \\ \tau_z^B \end{bmatrix} = Fw = \begin{bmatrix} c_f e_3 & c_f e_3 & c_f e_3 & c_f e_3 \\ c_d e_3 + c_f \rho_1^B \times e_3 & -c_d e_3 + c_f \rho_2^B \times e_3 & c_d e_3 + c_f \rho_3^B \times e_3 & -c_d e_3 + c_f \rho_4^B \times e_3 \end{bmatrix} w, \quad \omega = F^{-1}T$$

Trajectory Optimization



Trajectory Optimization

$$\min_{\boldsymbol{x}(t), \boldsymbol{u}(t)} J(\boldsymbol{u}(t), \boldsymbol{x}(t))$$

$$\text{subject to} \quad \dot{\boldsymbol{x}}(t) = f(\boldsymbol{x}(t), \boldsymbol{u}(t))$$

$$\boldsymbol{x}(0) = \bar{\boldsymbol{x}}_0$$

$$\boldsymbol{x}(T) = \bar{\boldsymbol{x}}_T$$

$$\boldsymbol{u}_{min} \leq \boldsymbol{u}(t) \leq \boldsymbol{u}_{max}$$

$$\boldsymbol{x}_{min} \leq \boldsymbol{x}(t) \leq \boldsymbol{x}_{max}$$

Trajectory optimization – flat output

$$J(\boldsymbol{\sigma}, \dot{\boldsymbol{\sigma}}, \ddot{\boldsymbol{\sigma}}, \dots) = \int_0^T (x^{(4)}(t))^2 dt + \int_0^T y^{(4)}(t)^2 dt + \int_0^T z^{(4)}(t)^2 dt + \int_0^T \psi^{(2)}(t)^2 dt$$

$$\boldsymbol{\sigma}(0) = \boldsymbol{\sigma}_0 \quad (\text{initial state})$$

$$\boldsymbol{\sigma}^{(1)}(0) = \boldsymbol{\sigma}_0^{(1)} \quad (\text{first derivative at starting point})$$

$$\vdots$$

$$\boldsymbol{\sigma}^{(q)}(0) = \boldsymbol{\sigma}_0^{(q)} \quad (\text{q-th derivative at starting point})$$

$$\boldsymbol{\sigma}(T) = \boldsymbol{\sigma}_T \quad (\text{final state})$$

$$\boldsymbol{\sigma}^{(1)}(T) = \boldsymbol{\sigma}_T^{(1)} \quad (\text{first derivative at end point})$$

$$\vdots$$

$$\boldsymbol{\sigma}^{(q)}(T) = \boldsymbol{\sigma}_T^{(q)} \quad (\text{q-th derivative at end point})$$

$$\boldsymbol{\sigma}(t) = [x, y, z, \psi]^T$$

Trajectory Optimization –Euler Lagrange method

- Assumption: polynomial with fixed degree

$$P(t) = p_N t^N + p_{N-1} t^{N-1} + \dots + p_2 t^2 + p_1 t + p_0$$

$$\underset{P(t)}{\text{minimize}} \quad \int_0^T (P^{(r)}(t))^2 dt$$

$$\text{subject to} \quad P(0) = x_0$$

$$\vdots$$

$$P^{(q)}(0) = x_0^{(q)}$$

$$P(T) = x_T$$

$$\vdots$$

$$P^{(q)}(T) = x_T^{(q)}$$

$$\frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial x} - \frac{d}{dt} \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \dot{x}} = 0$$

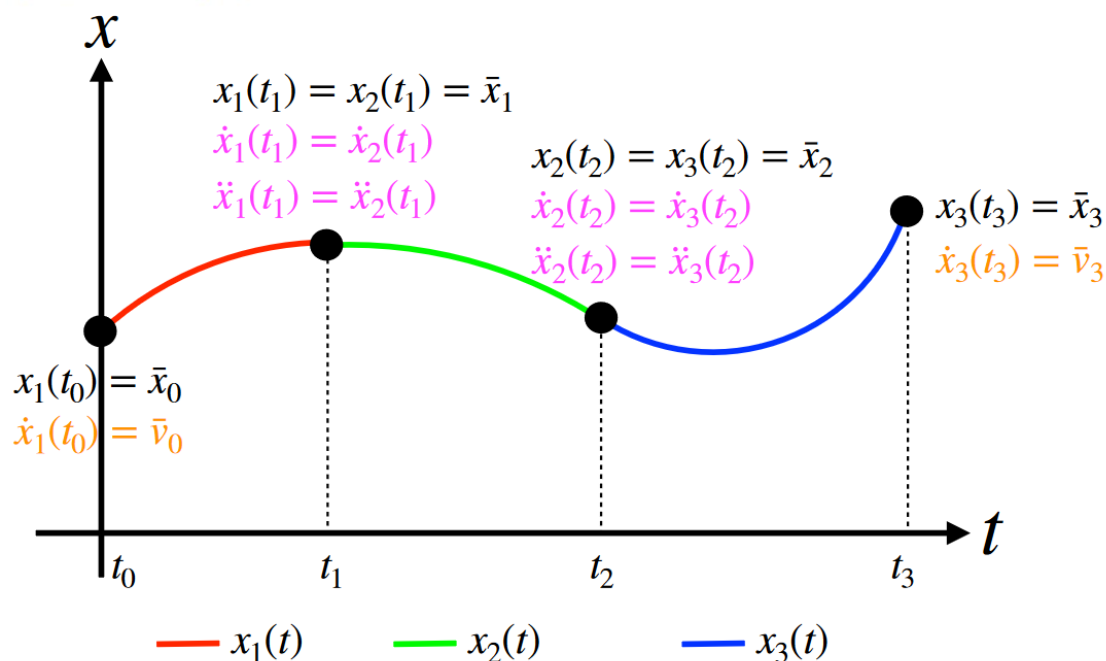
$$\sum_{k=0}^r (-1)^k \frac{d^k}{dt^k} \left(\frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial x^{(k)}} \right) = 0$$

Minimum Snap Trajectory Optimization

$$\frac{d^4}{dt^4} \left(\frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial P^{(4)}} \right) = 0 \Rightarrow \frac{d^4}{dt^4} \left(2P^{(4)}(t) \right) = 0 \Rightarrow \frac{d^8}{dt^8} P(t) = 0$$

$$P(t) = p_7 t^7 + p_6 t^6 + p_5 t^5 + p_4 t^4 + \dots + p_1 t^1 + p_0$$

$$\mathbf{A}_{8 \times 8} \mathbf{p} = \mathbf{b}_{8 \times 1}$$



QP-based Trajectory Optimization

$$\begin{array}{ll}\text{minimize}_{P(t)} & \int_0^T (P^{(r)}(t))^2 dt \\ \text{subject to} & P(0) = \bar{x}_0\end{array}$$

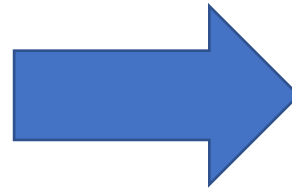
$$\vdots$$

$$P^{(q)}(0) = x_0^{(q)}$$

$$P(T) = \bar{x}_T$$

$$\vdots$$

$$P^{(q)}(T) = x_T^{(q)}$$



$$\begin{array}{ll}\min & p^\top Q p \\ \text{subject to} & A p = b\end{array}$$

$$P(t) = p_N t^N + p_{N-1} t^{N-1} + \ldots + p_2 t^2 + p_1 t + p_0$$

$$\underset{P(t)}{\text{minimize}} \quad \int_0^T (P^{(r)}(t))^2 dt$$

$$\text{subject to} \quad P(0) = x_0$$

$$\vdots$$

$$P^{(q)}(0) = x_0^{(q)}$$

$$P(T) = x_T$$

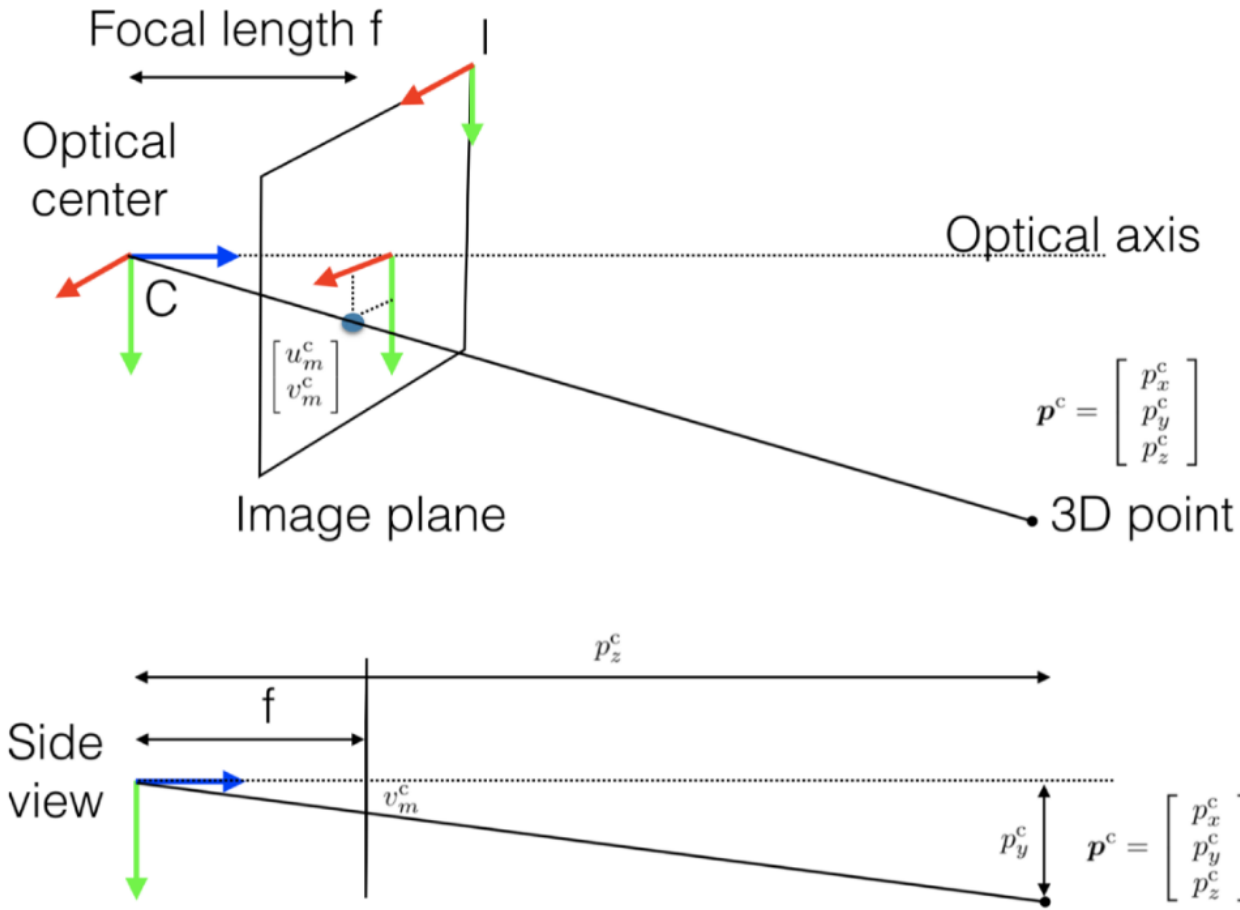
$$\vdots$$

$$P^{(q)}(T) = x_T^{(q)}$$

$$J = \boldsymbol{p}^\top \boldsymbol{Q} \boldsymbol{p} = \sum_{l=0}^N \sum_{k=0}^N Q_{lk} p_l p_k$$

$$Q_{lk} = \begin{cases} \prod_{m=0}^{r-1} (l-m)(k-m) \frac{T^{l+k-2r+1}}{l+k-2r+1} & l \geq r \wedge k \geq r \\ 0 & l < r \vee k < r \end{cases}, \quad \text{and } Q_{kl} = Q_{lk}$$

Camera Pinhole Model

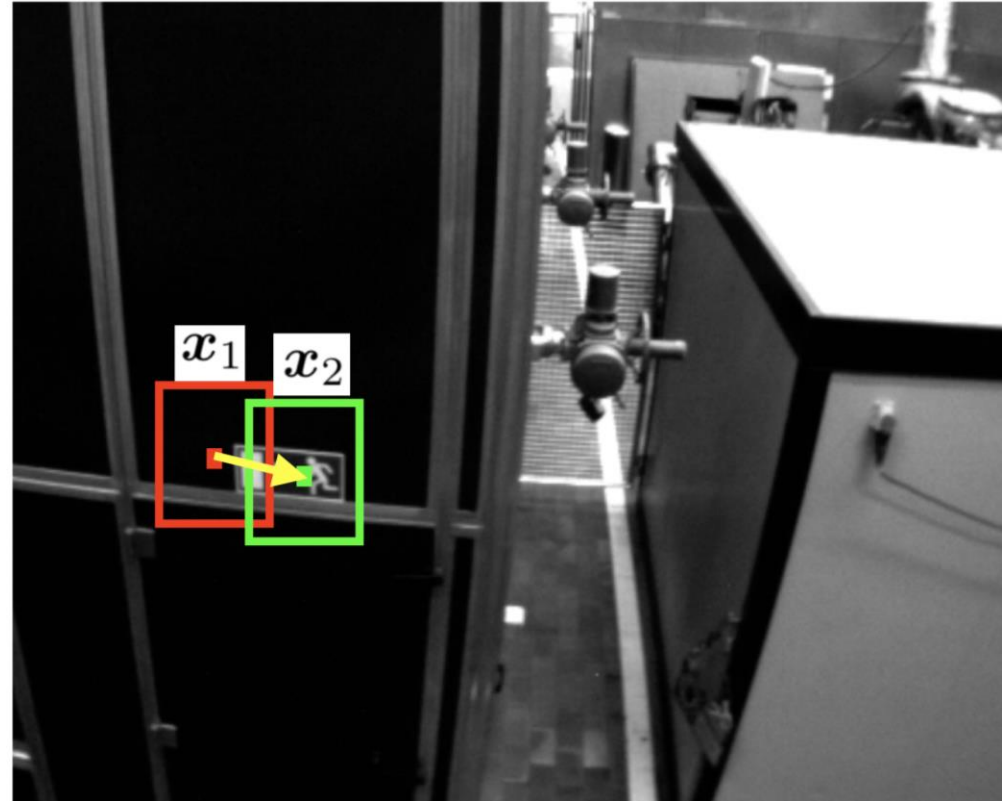
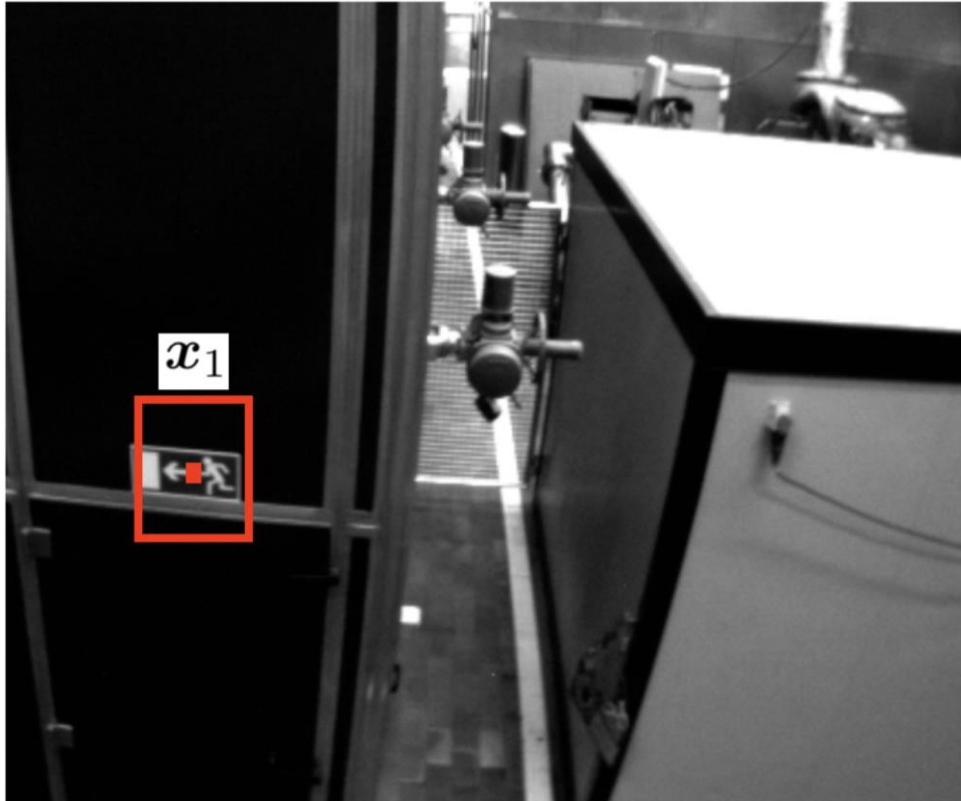


$$p_z^c \begin{bmatrix} u_m^c \\ v_m^c \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} f & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & f & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} p_x^c \\ p_y^c \\ p_z^c \end{bmatrix}$$

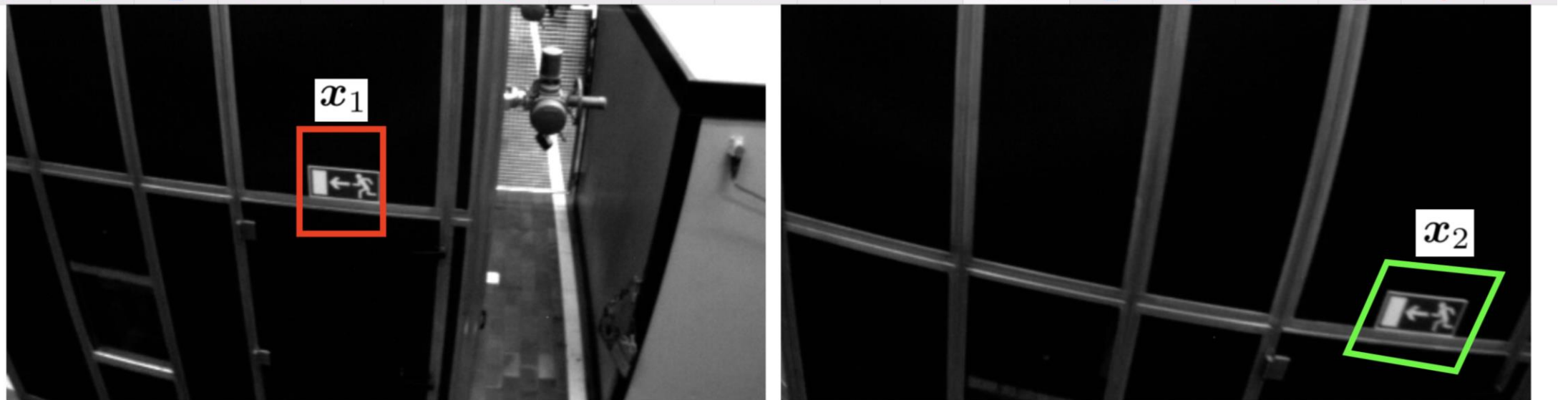
$$p_z^c \begin{bmatrix} u^I \\ v^I \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} = \overbrace{\begin{bmatrix} s_x f & s_\theta f & o_x \\ 0 & s_y f & o_y \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}}^{\text{intrinsic calibration}} \overbrace{\begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{R}_w^c & \mathbf{t}_w^c \end{bmatrix}}^{\text{extrinsic calibration}} \tilde{\mathbf{p}}^w = \mathbf{\Pi} \tilde{\mathbf{p}}^w$$

Figure 11.1: Pinhole Model.

Feature Extraction and Tracking

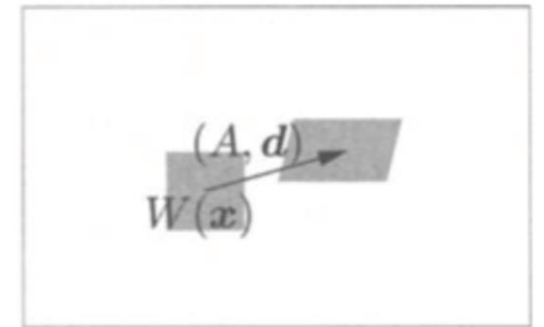
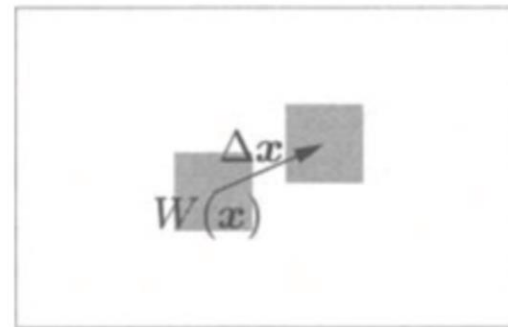


Feature Extraction and Tracking

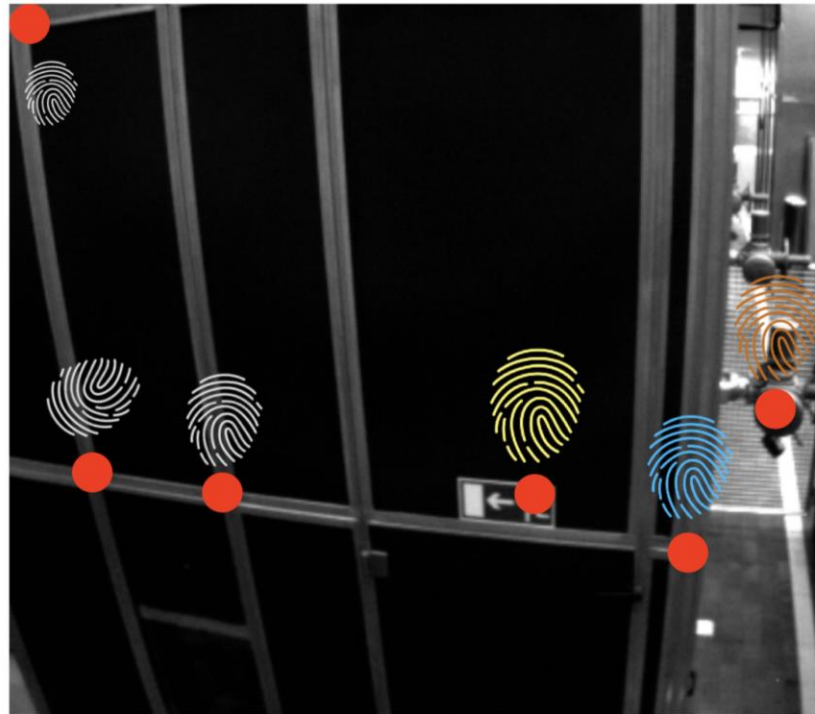


$$\min_{A, \delta} \sum_{y \in W(x_1)} \|\mathcal{I}_1(y) - \mathcal{I}_2(Ay + \delta)\|^2$$

(affine motion model)



Descriptor-based Feature matching

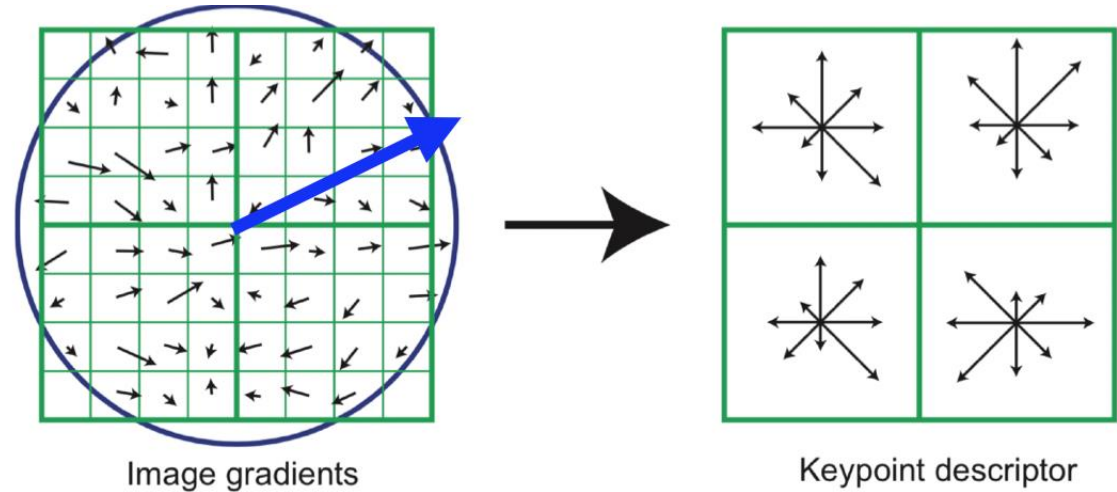


Descriptor is a signature we attach to a (point) feature, that describes local appearance

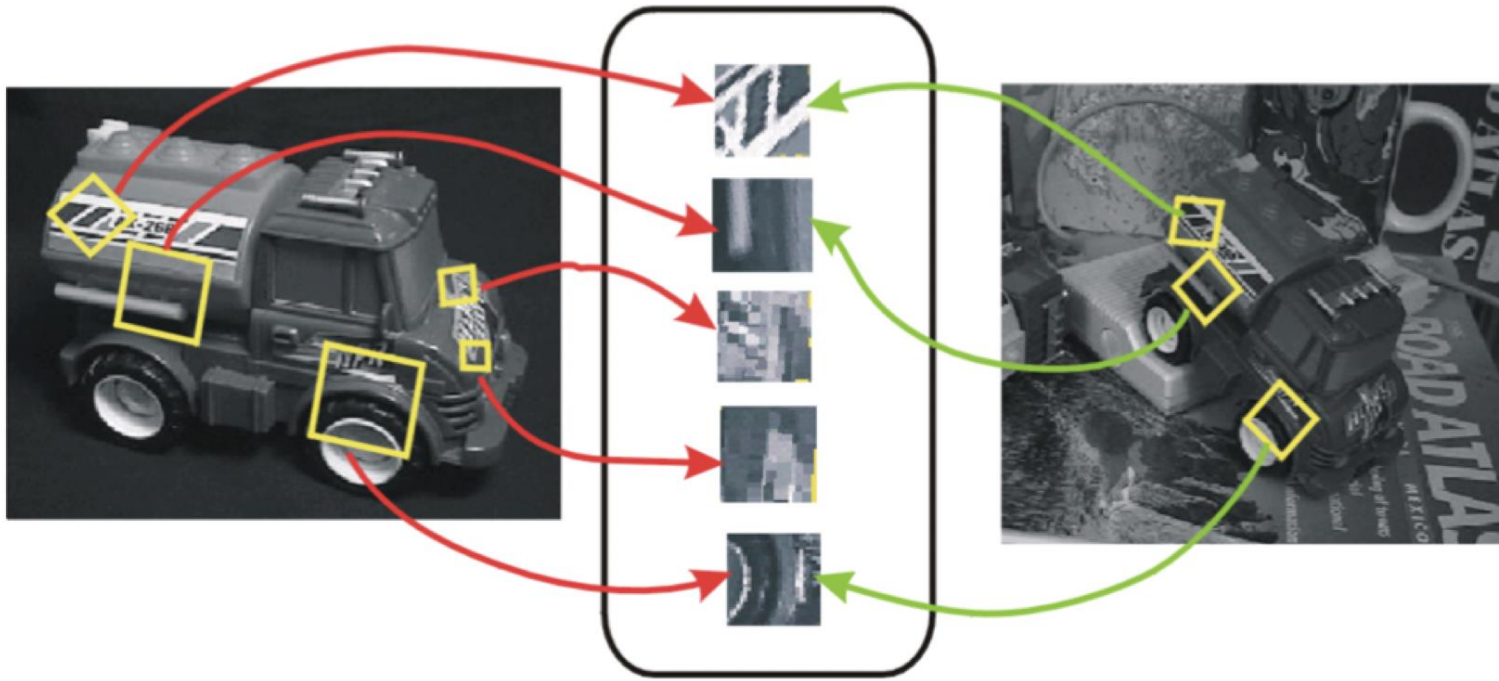
SIFT Descriptor

How to get SIFT descriptor?

- Transform all gradients with respect to (main) orientation
- Split window in 16 squares and for each compute a histogram with 8 sectors
- Stack histogram into a **descriptor** vector of $16 \times 8 = 128$ scalars
- Normalize to have norm = 1



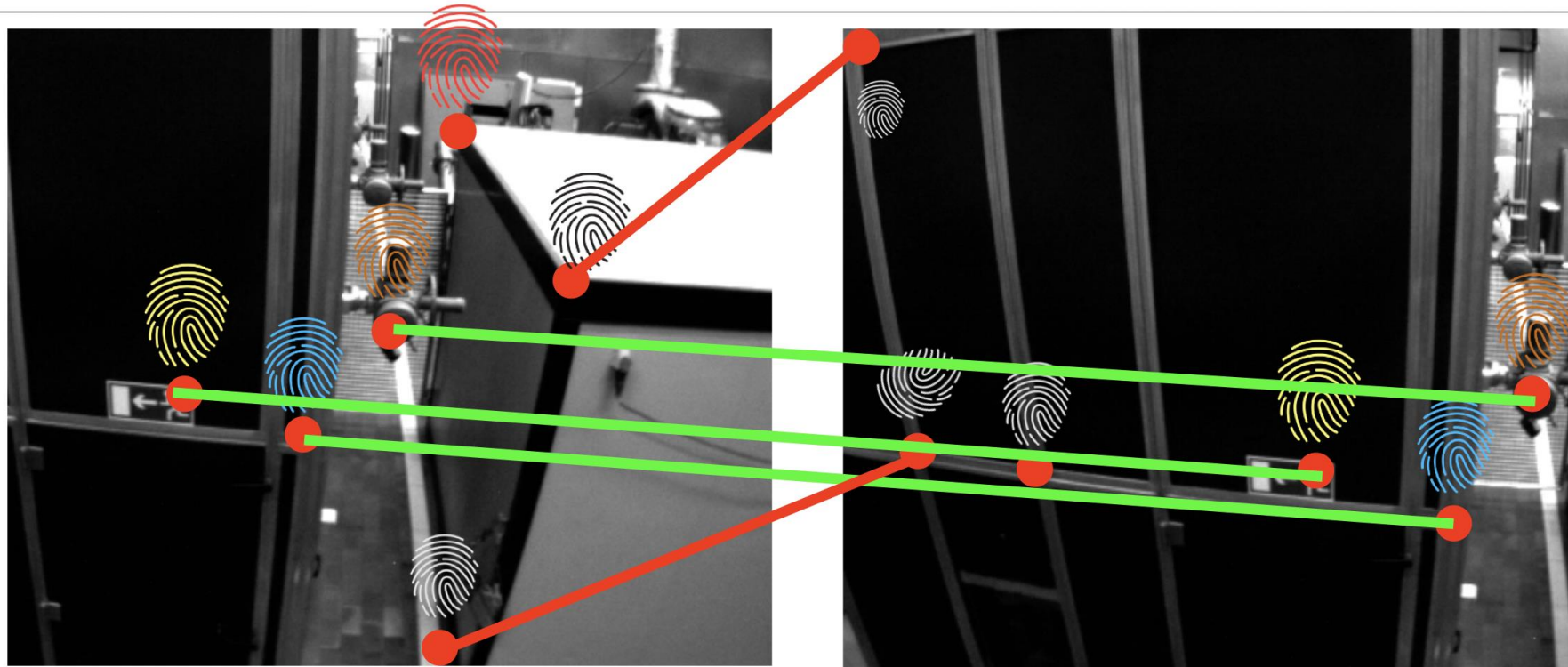
Feature Matching



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- For each descriptor in I_1 find closest descriptor in I_2 (nearest neighbor)
- Speed up with **approximate** nearest neighbor algorithms (FLANN library)

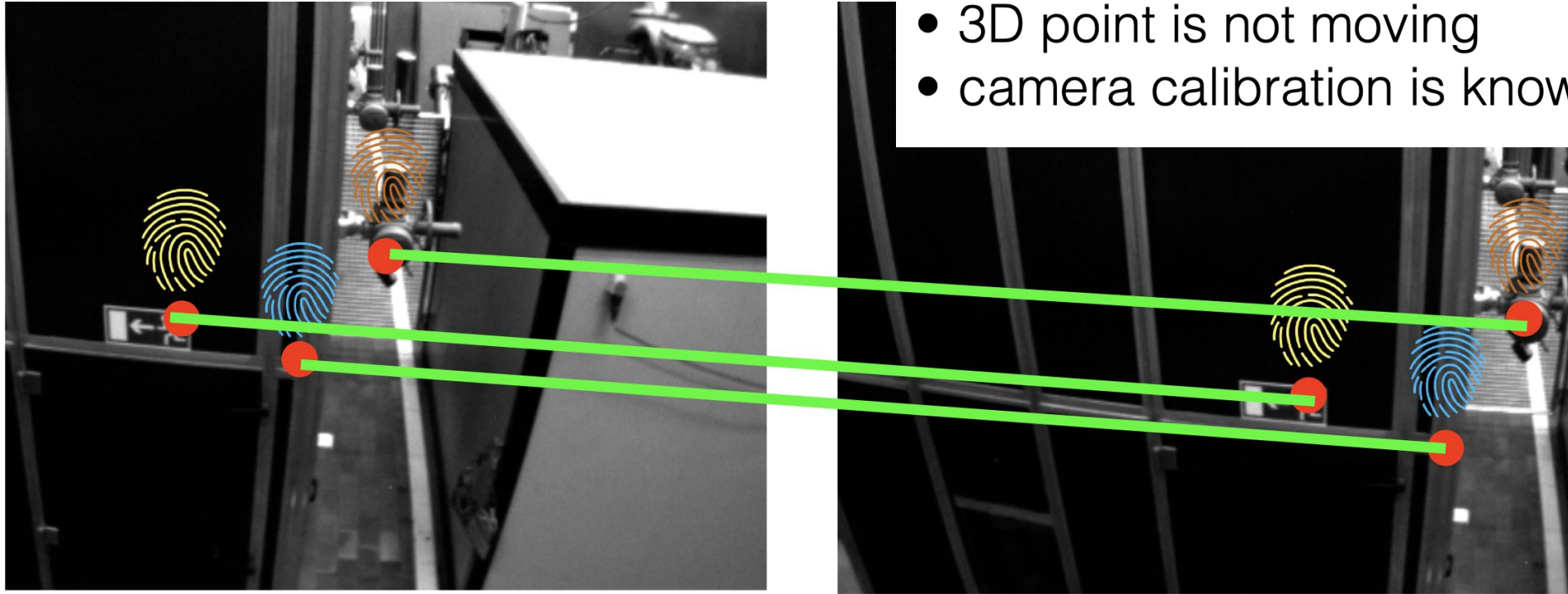
Pose Estimation: 2-view Geometry



Question: can we estimate the motion of the camera between I_1 and I_2 using pixel correspondences?

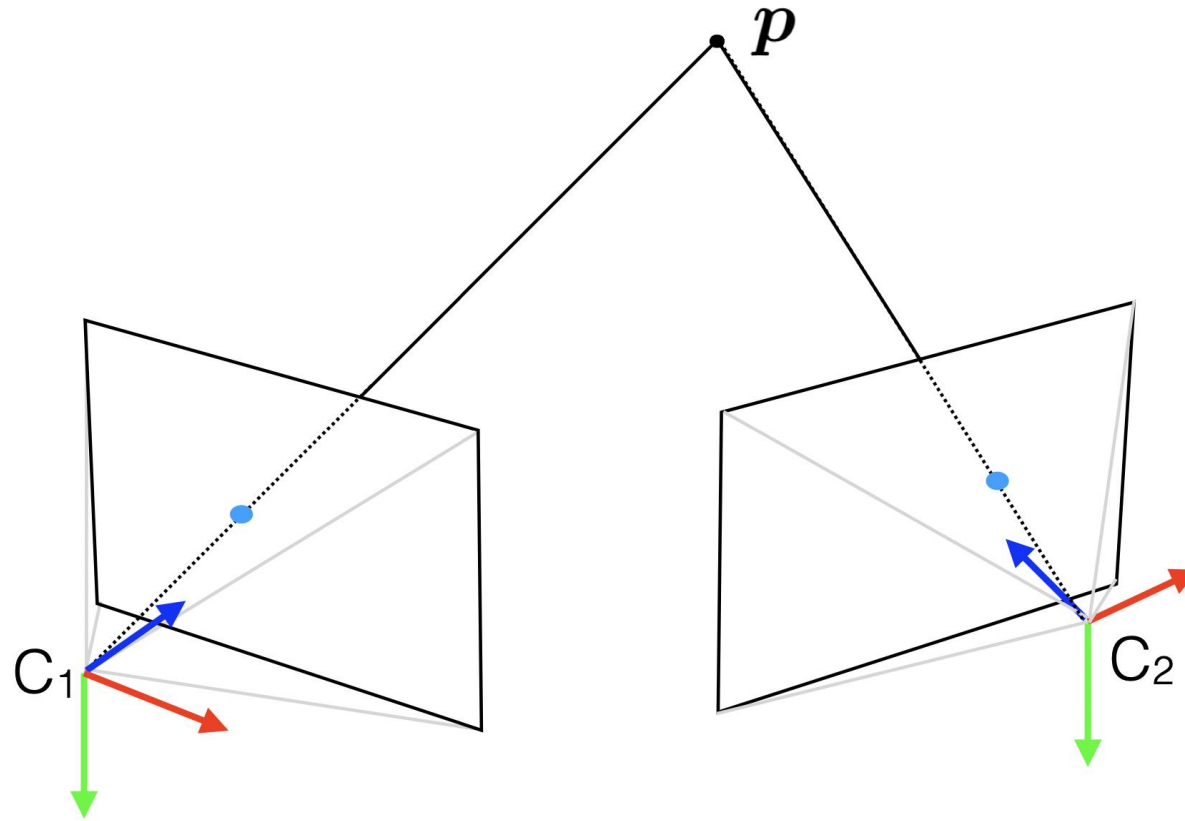
Pose Estimation: 2-view Geometry

- no wrong correspondences (outliers)
- 3D point is not moving
- camera calibration is known



Question: can we estimate the motion of the camera between I_1 and I_2 using pixel correspondences?

2-view Geometry



$$p_z^{c_1} \tilde{x}_1 = K_1 [R_w^{c_1} t_w^{c_1}] \tilde{p}^w$$

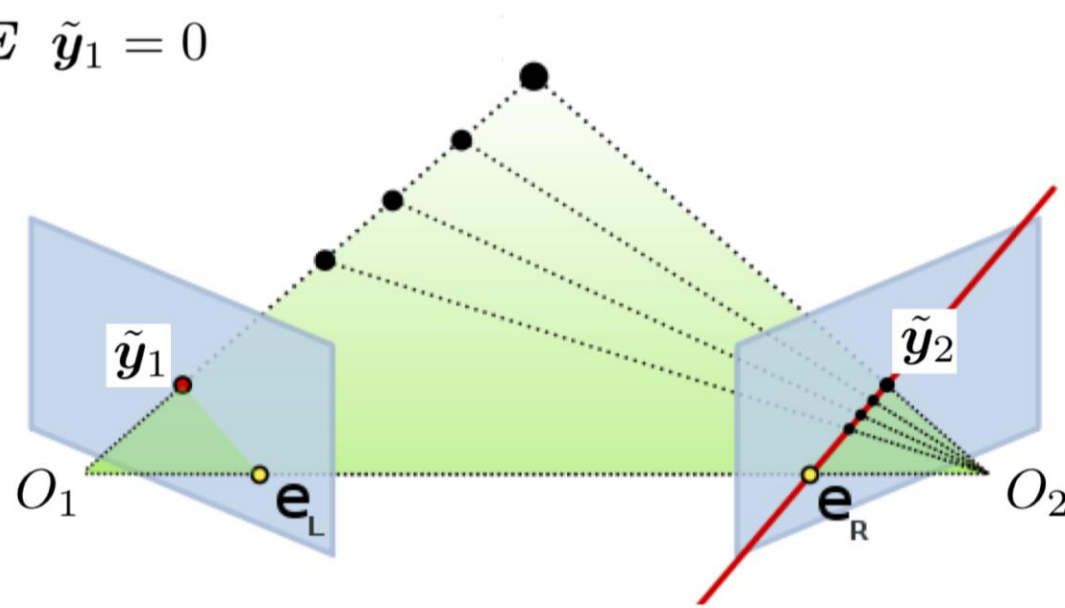
$$K_1 = \begin{bmatrix} s_{x_1} f_1 & s_{\theta_1} f_1 & o_{x_1} \\ 0 & s_{y_1} f_1 & o_{y_1} \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$p_z^{c_2} \tilde{x}_2 = K_2 [R_w^{c_2} t_w^{c_2}] \tilde{p}^w$$

$$K_2 = \begin{bmatrix} s_{x_2} f_2 & s_{\theta_2} f_2 & o_{x_2} \\ 0 & s_{y_2} f_2 & o_{y_2} \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

Epipolar Geometry

$$\tilde{\mathbf{y}}_2^T \mathbf{E} \tilde{\mathbf{y}}_1 = 0$$



2-view Geometry and Epipolar Equation

Given N calibrated pixel correspondences:

$$(\tilde{\mathbf{y}}_{1,k}, \tilde{\mathbf{y}}_{2,k}) \text{ for } k = 1, \dots, N$$

1. leverage the epipolar constraints to estimate the essential matrix $\mathbf{E}$

$$\tilde{\mathbf{y}}_{2,k}^\top \mathbf{E} \tilde{\mathbf{y}}_{1,k} = 0$$

2. Retrieve the rotation and translation (up to scale) from the $\mathbf{E}$

$$\mathbf{E} = [\mathbf{t}]_\times \mathbf{R}$$

Estimation of poses from correspondence

Given N calibrated pixel correspondences:

$$(\tilde{\mathbf{y}}_{1,k}, \tilde{\mathbf{y}}_{2,k}) \text{ for } k = 1, \dots, N$$

1. leverage the epipolar constraints to estimate the essential matrix $\mathbf{E}$

$$\tilde{\mathbf{y}}_{2,k}^\top \mathbf{E} \tilde{\mathbf{y}}_{1,k} = 0$$

For 8 points: $\mathbf{A}\mathbf{e} = 0$ $N > 8$ points: $\arg \min_{\|\mathbf{e}\|=1} \|\mathbf{A}\mathbf{e}\|^2$

2. Retrieve the rotation and translation (up to scale) from the $\mathbf{E}$

$$\mathbf{E} = [\mathbf{t}]_{\times} \mathbf{R}$$

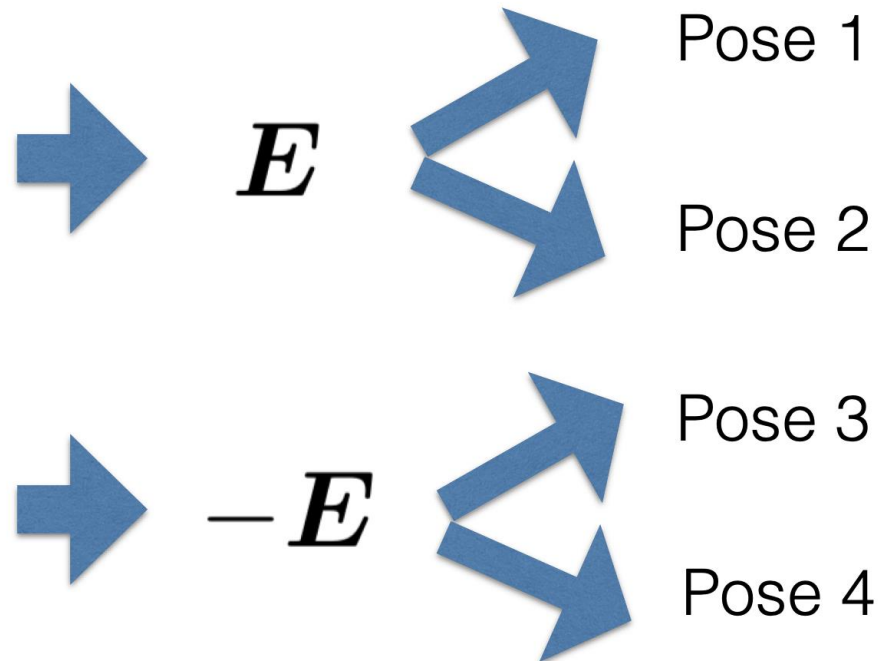
Retrieve Pose from Essential Matrix

Theorem 1 (Pose recovery from essential matrix, Thm 5.7 in [1]). *There exist exactly two relative poses $(\mathbf{R}, \mathbf{t})$ with $\mathbf{R} \in \text{SO}(3)$ and $\mathbf{t} \in \mathbb{R}^3$ corresponding to a nonzero essential matrix $\mathbf{E}$ (i.e., such that $\mathbf{E} = [\mathbf{t}]_{\times} \mathbf{R}$):*

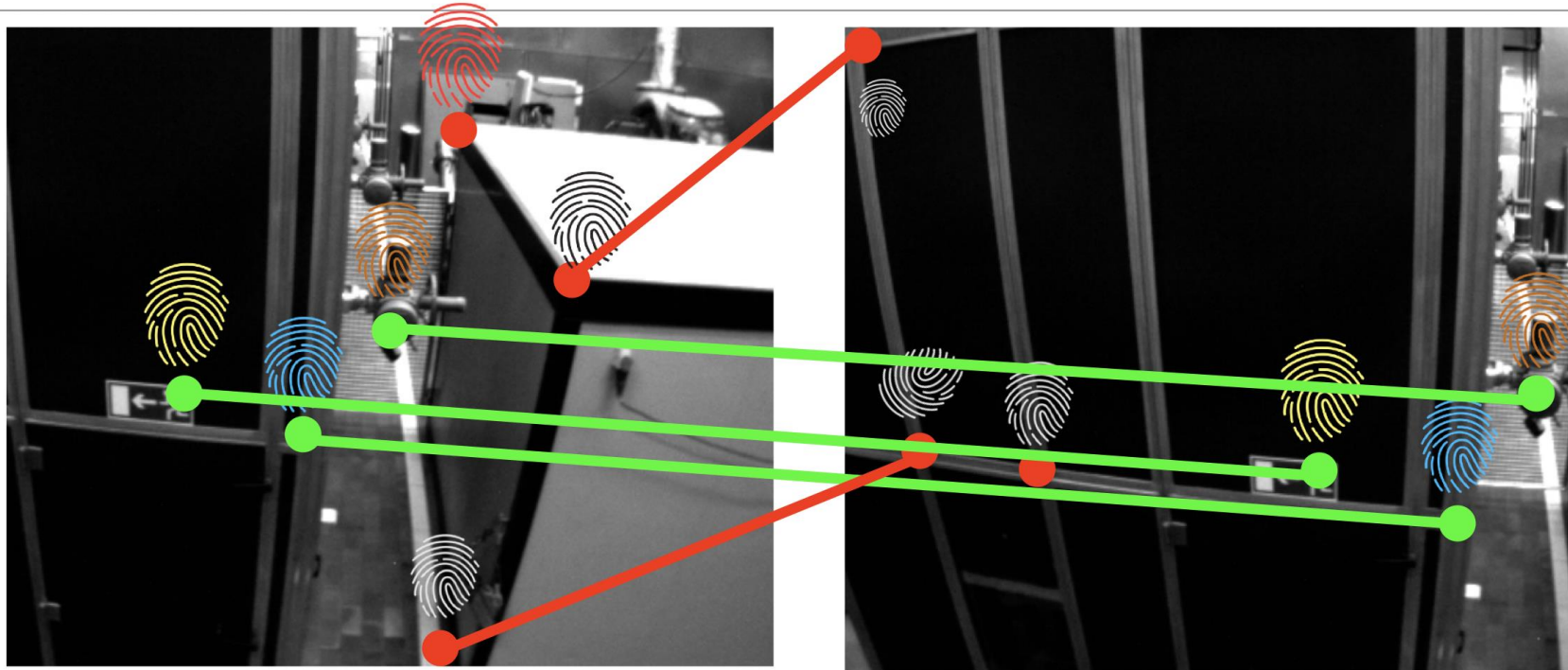
$$\mathbf{t}_1 = \mathbf{U} \mathbf{R}_z(+\pi/2) \mathbf{\Sigma} \mathbf{U}^{\top} \quad \mathbf{R}_1 = \mathbf{U} \mathbf{R}_z(+\pi/2) \mathbf{V}^{\top} \quad (13.19)$$

$$\mathbf{t}_2 = \mathbf{U} \mathbf{R}_z(-\pi/2) \mathbf{\Sigma} \mathbf{U}^{\top} \quad \mathbf{R}_2 = \mathbf{U} \mathbf{R}_z(-\pi/2) \mathbf{V}^{\top} \quad (13.20)$$

where $\mathbf{E} = \mathbf{U} \mathbf{\Sigma} \mathbf{V}^{\top}$ is the singular value decomposition of the matrix $\mathbf{E}$, and $\mathbf{R}_z(+\pi/2)$ is an elementary rotation around the z -axis of an angle $\pi/2$.



2-View Geometry limitation



In practice:

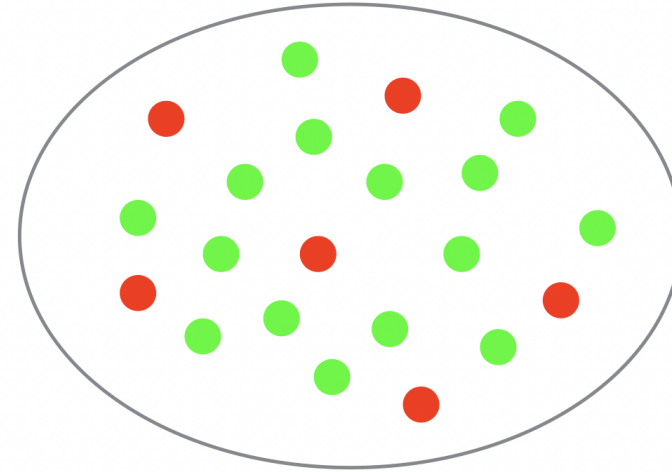
- Many wrong correspondences (outliers)
- Some 3D points might be moving

Solution: RANSAC Algorithm

RANdom **SA**mples **C**onsensus

Problem: estimate model P from N data points, possibly corrupted with outliers.

Assume: we have an algorithm to estimate P from n data points ($n \ll N$)

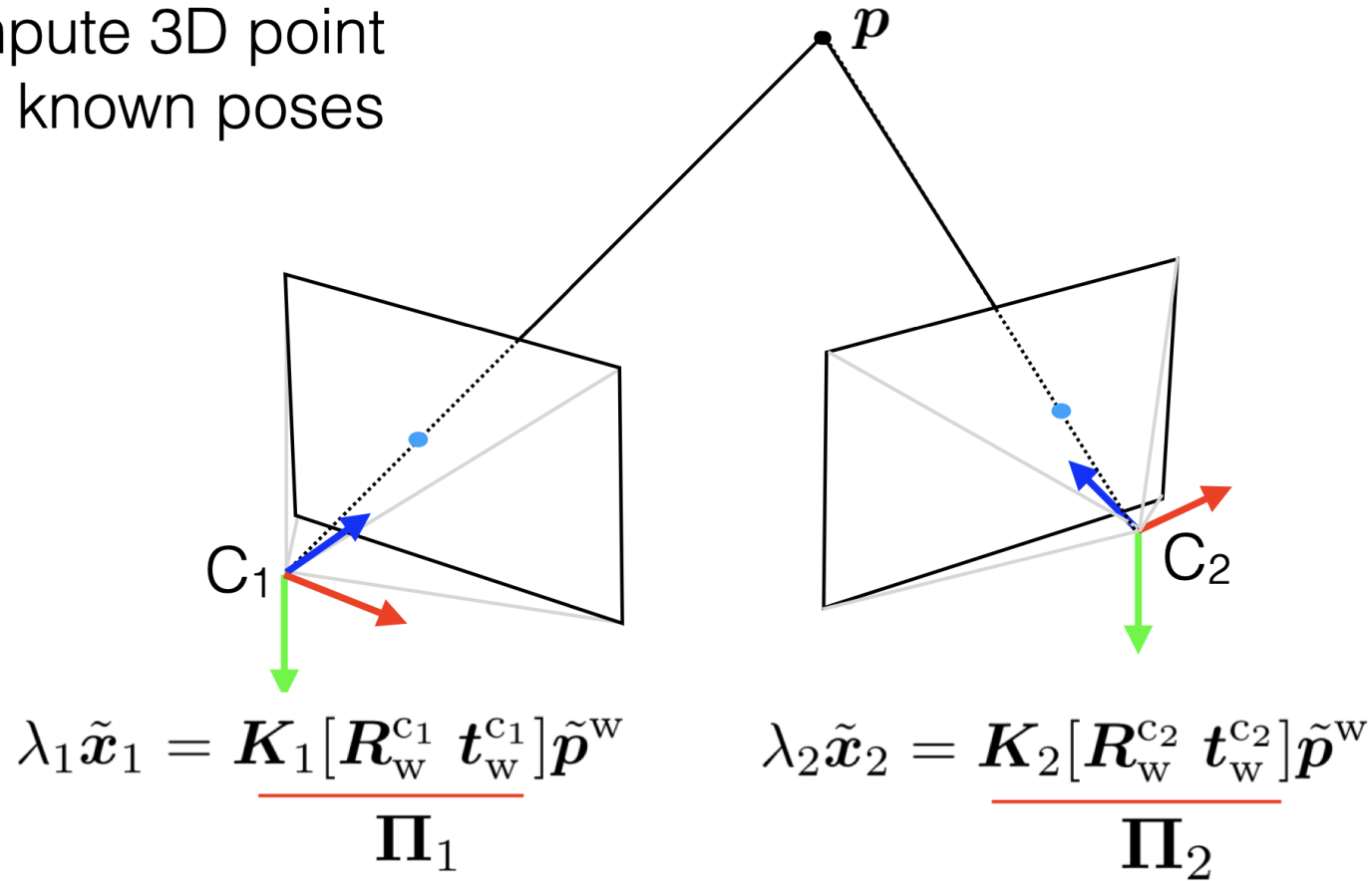


Basic idea:

1. sample n points
2. compute an estimate P' of P
3. count how many other points agree with P'
4. repeat until you get a P' that agrees with many points

Triangulation

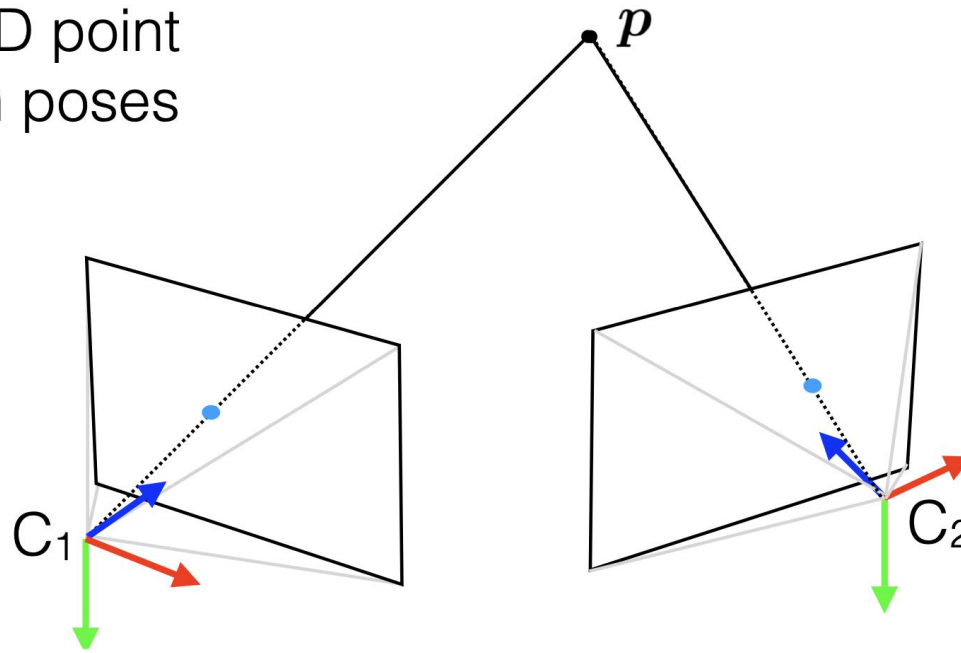
Compute 3D point
from known poses



Linear triangulation: $\min_{\|\tilde{p}^w\|=1} \|A\tilde{p}^w\|^2$

Triangulation

Compute 3D point
from known poses

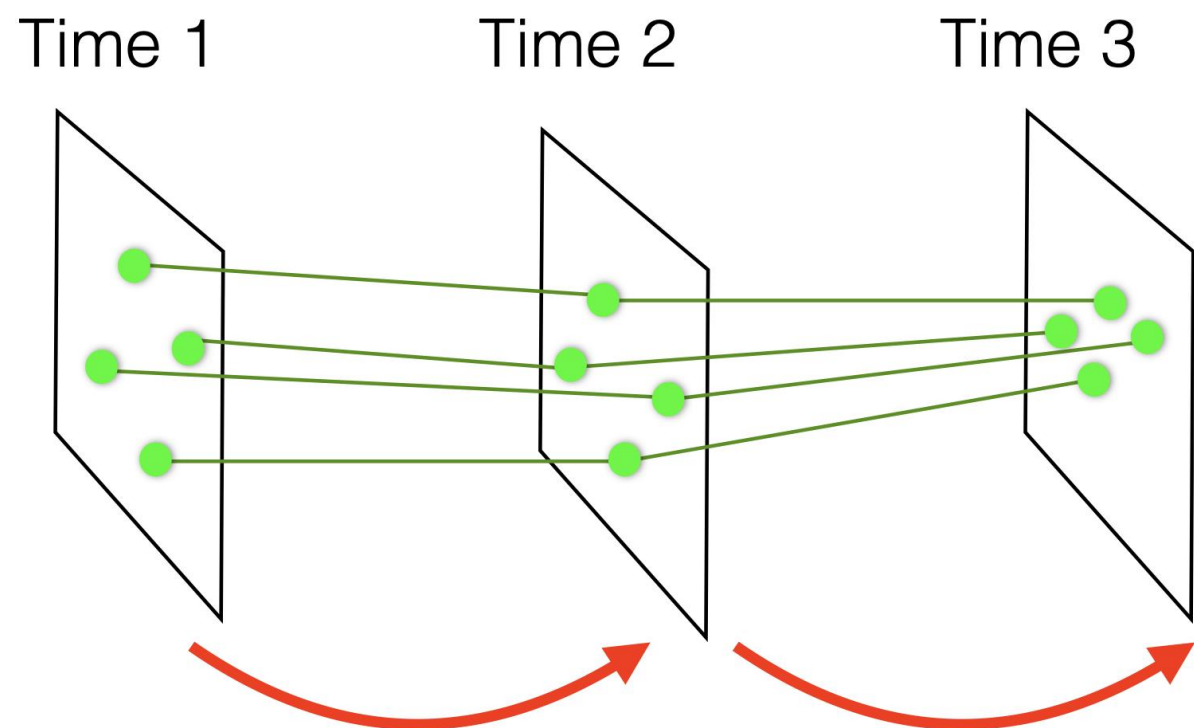


$$\lambda_1 \tilde{\mathbf{x}}_1 = \underbrace{\mathbf{K}_1 [\mathbf{R}_w^{c_1} \mathbf{t}_w^{c_1}]}_{\Pi_1} \tilde{\mathbf{p}}^w$$

$$\lambda_2 \tilde{\mathbf{x}}_2 = \underbrace{\mathbf{K}_2 [\mathbf{R}_w^{c_2} \mathbf{t}_w^{c_2}]}_{\Pi_2} \tilde{\mathbf{p}}^w$$

$$\min_{\mathbf{p}^w} \|\mathbf{x}_1 - \pi(\mathbf{R}_{c_1}^w, \mathbf{t}_{c_1}^w, \mathbf{p}^w)\|^2 + \|\mathbf{x}_2 - \pi(\mathbf{R}_{c_2}^w, \mathbf{t}_{c_2}^w, \mathbf{p}^w)\|^2$$

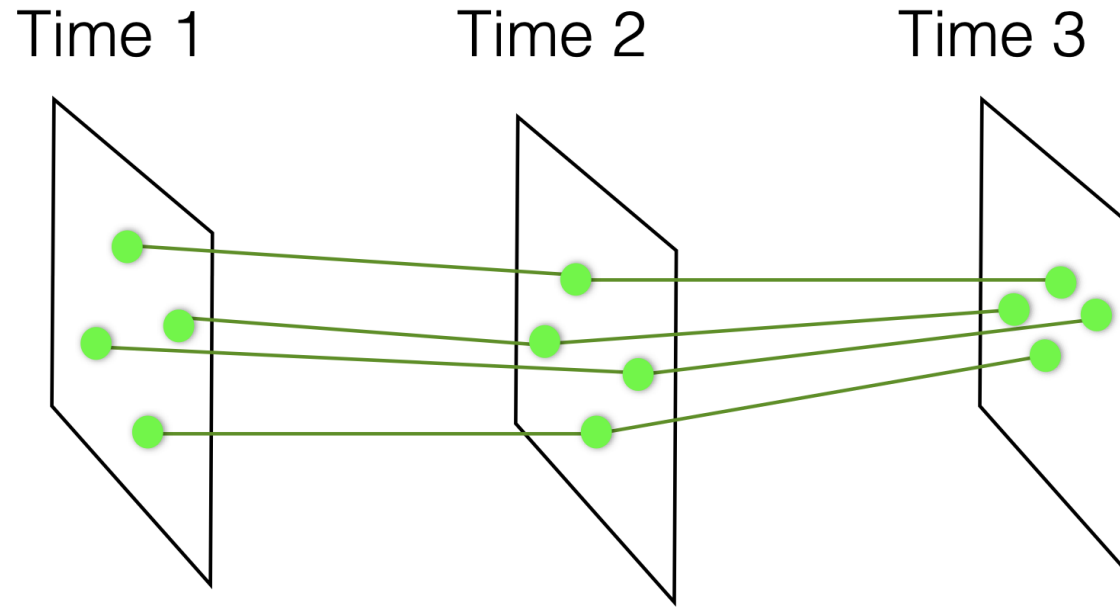
Motion Estimation



$$\mathbf{E}_{12} = \arg \min_{\mathbf{E}_{12} \in \mathcal{S}_E} \sum_{k=1}^N |\tilde{\mathbf{y}}_{k,2}^T \mathbf{E}_{12} \tilde{\mathbf{y}}_{k,1}|^2$$

$$\mathbf{E}_{23} = \arg \min_{\mathbf{E}_{23} \in \mathcal{S}_E} \sum_{k=1}^N |\tilde{\mathbf{y}}_{k,3}^T \mathbf{E}_{23} \tilde{\mathbf{y}}_{k,2}|^2$$

Motion And Structure Estimation



$$\min_{\substack{(\mathbf{R}_{c_i}^w, \mathbf{t}_{c_i}^w), i=1,2,3 \\ \mathbf{p}_k^w, k=1,\dots,N}} \sum_{k=1}^N \sum_{i=1}^3 \|\mathbf{x}_{k,i} - \pi(\mathbf{R}_{c_i}^w, \mathbf{t}_{c_i}^w, \mathbf{p}_k^w)\|^2$$

Generalizes to K cameras: **Bundle adjustment**

Place Recognition – Bag of Words

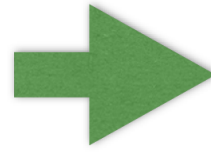
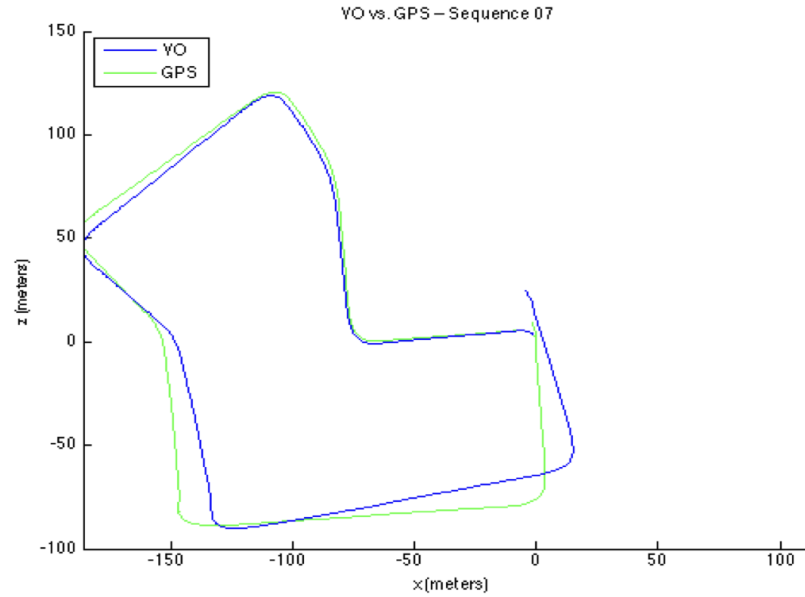
- Is pose estimation using visual (inertial) odometry enough?

No! the error is accumulated over the time

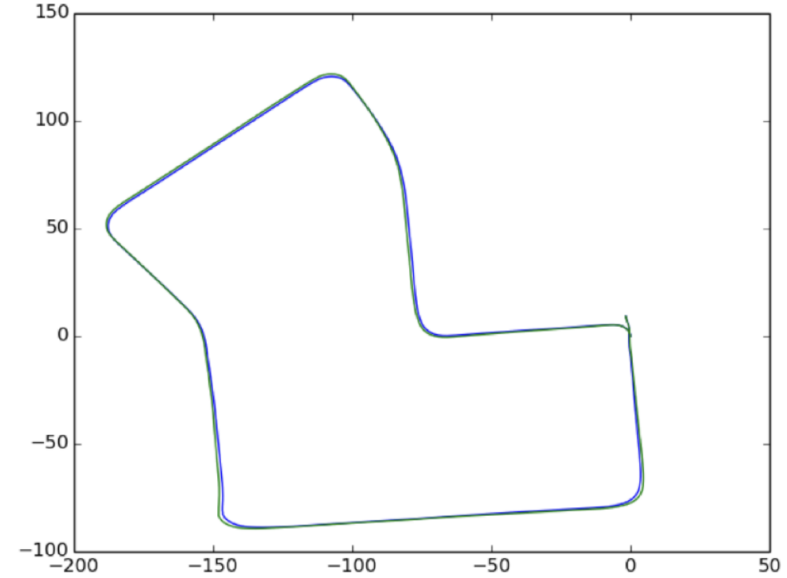
Solution:

- Loop Closure
- Place recognition for loop closure!

Visual odometry



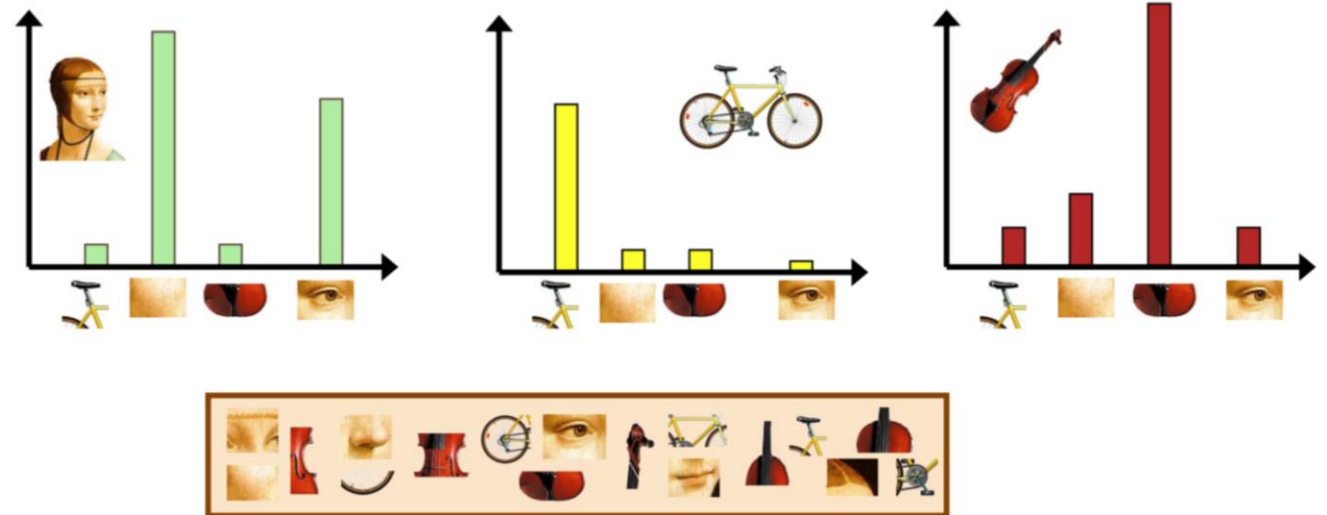
SLAM



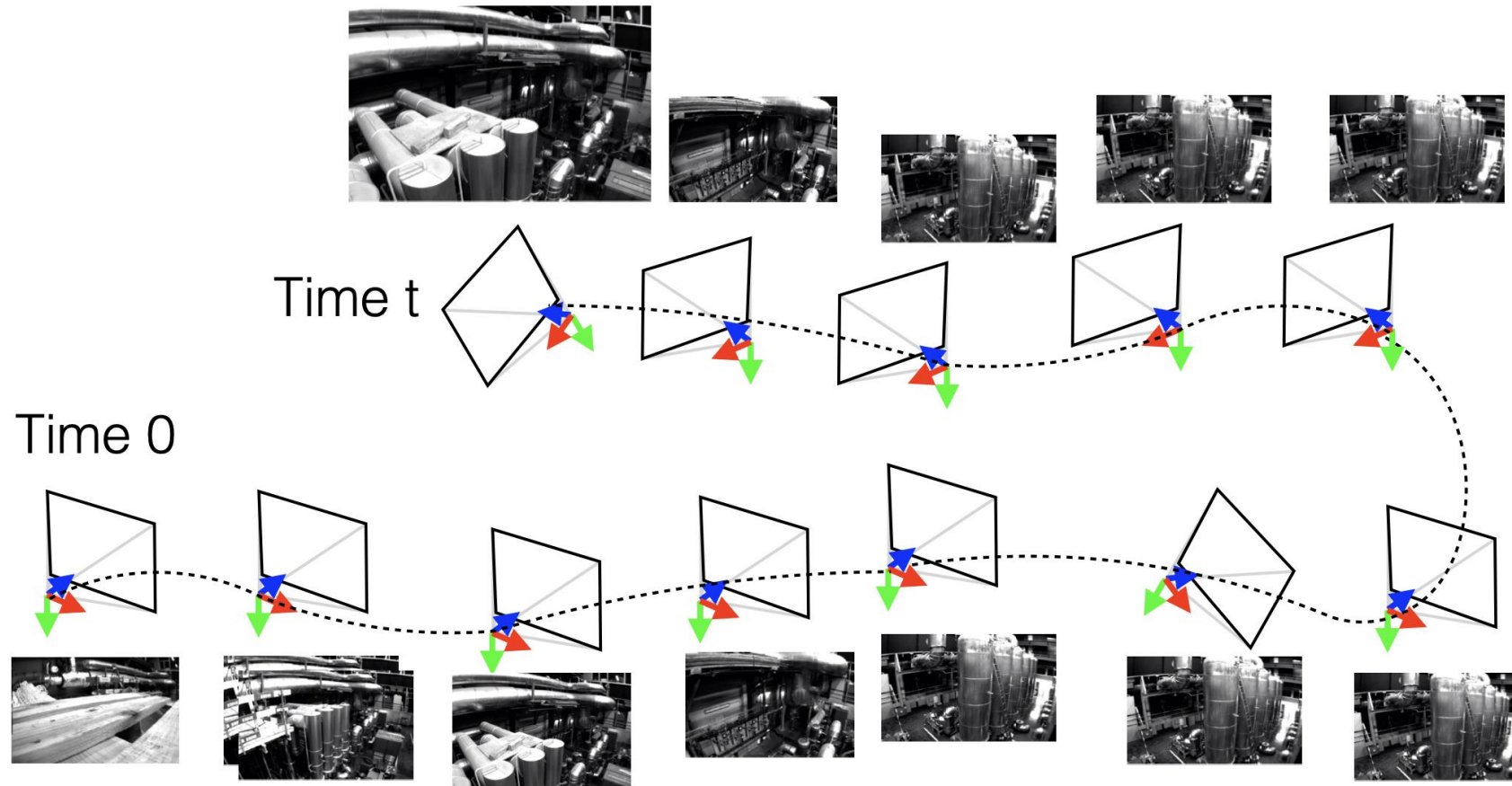
SLAM requires:

- place recognition => loop closure detection and / or
- Object detection => landmark detection

Bag of (visual) words



Place Recognition

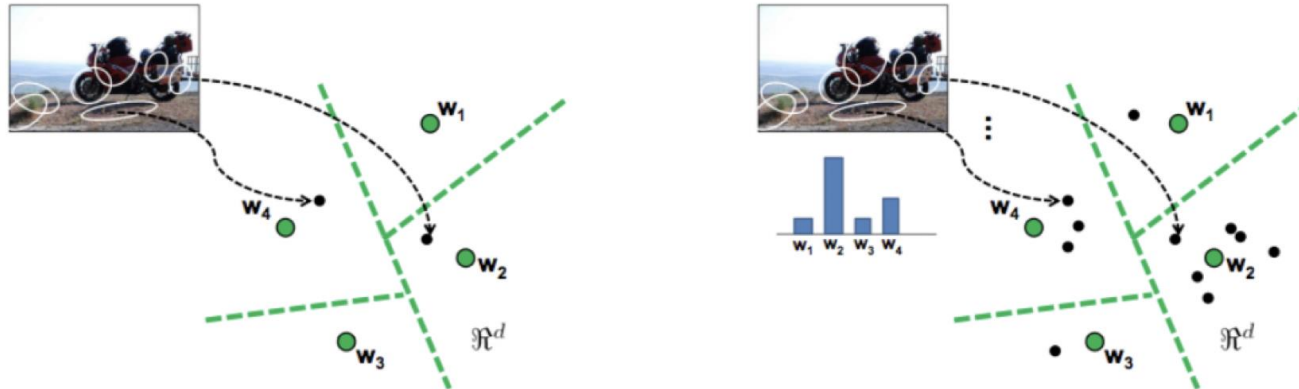


Does the image at time "t" picture a place
seen in previous images?

Local Descriptors and Place Recognition

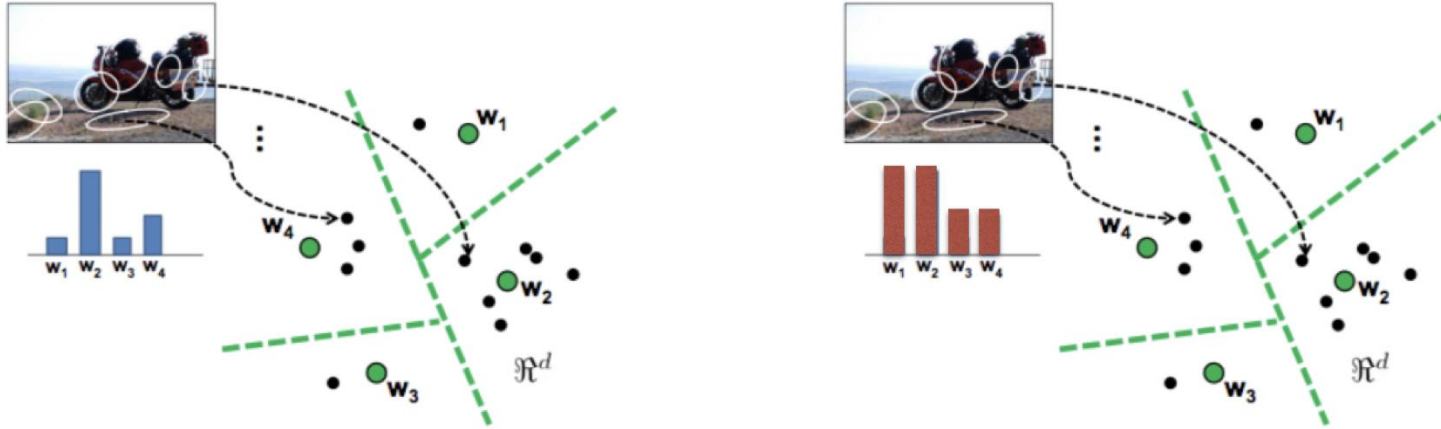
Based on text retrieval and summarization methods

- 1) Extract features and descriptors in image
- 2) Discretize feature space (clustering)
- 3) Store the frequency of the features for each image



Each cluster is a “visual word”
Typically 5k-10k (up to 100k) visual words

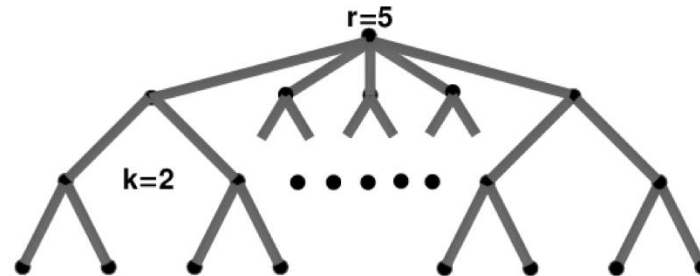
Local descriptors: Bag of Words



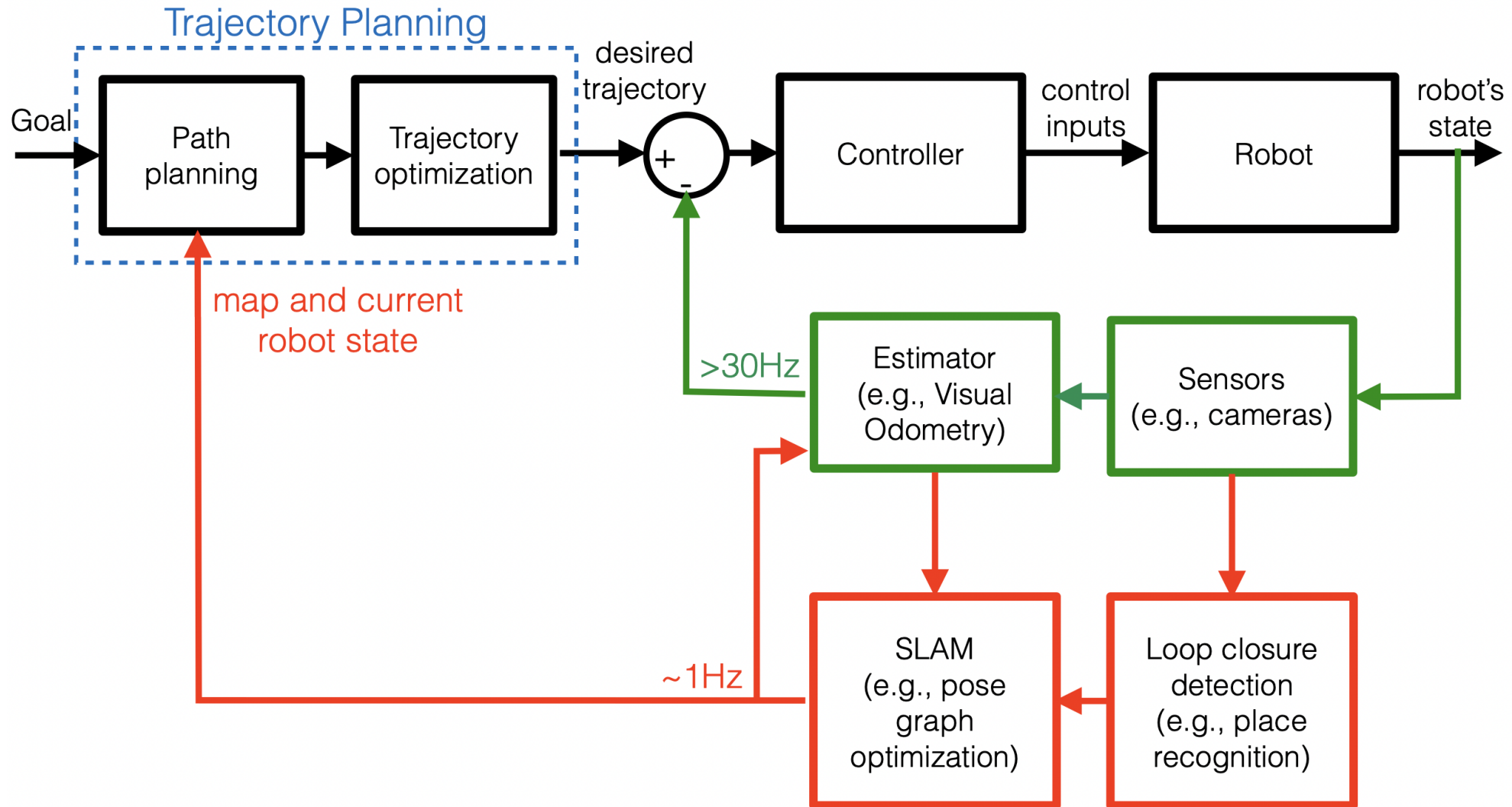
Two images are compared based on the corresponding histogram (Hamming distances, other metrics, ...)

Faster version: **vocabulary tree**

Alternatives: **VLAD** (Vector of Locally Aggregated Descriptors), **Fisher vectors**



Big Picture

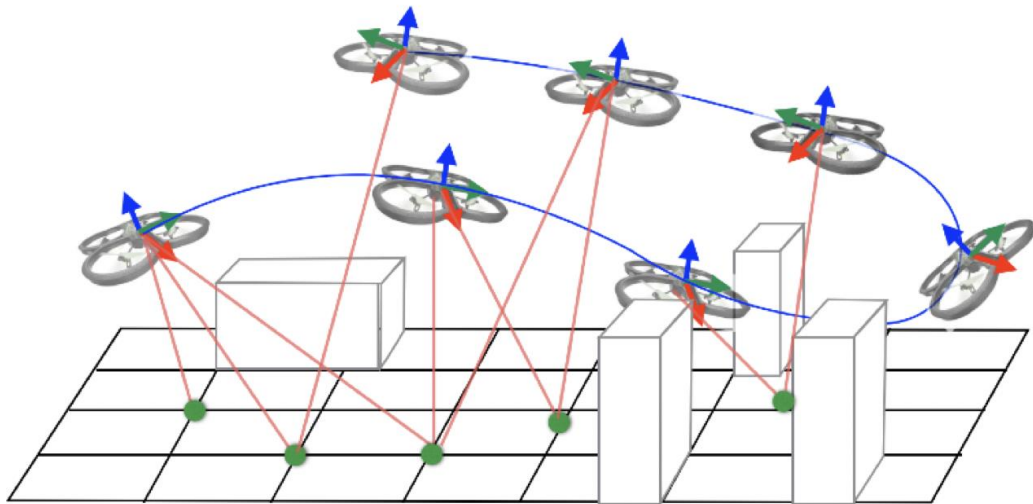
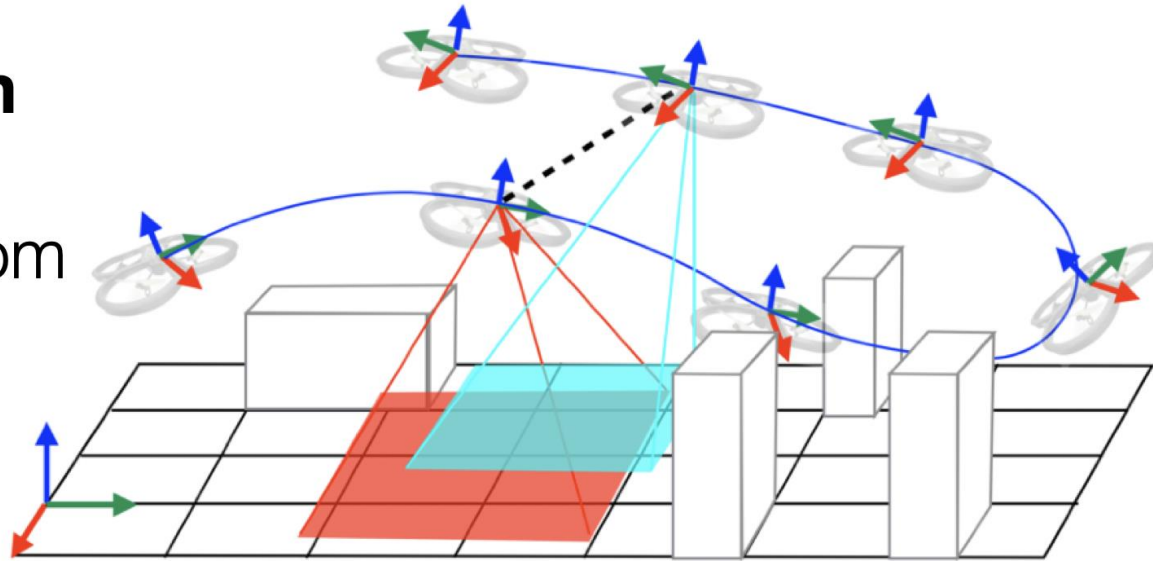


Simultaneous Localization and Mapping

Pose Graph Optimization

(a.k.a. pose SLAM):

Estimate only trajectory from sensor data



Landmark-based SLAM:

Estimate trajectory of robot and position of external landmarks from sensor data